PROJECT PHASE 08

Deployment, Release, and Maintenance

A practical release plan for taking LegalEase from a working local application to a supported deployment.

PROJECT	DOCUMENT	STATUS
LegalEase	Phase 8 plan	Release preparation

Objective

Prepare LegalEase for reliable use, publish the application to its intended environment, and establish a process for maintaining it after release.

Work included

01 Prepare the release

- Confirm the application starts using the documented setup steps.
- Configure the Gemini API key and other environment settings securely; keep secrets out of source control.
- Confirm that the frontend can reach the backend.

02 Verify key workflows

- Open the LegalEase interface and generate a draft using the configured provider.
- Edit the draft and export it as TXT, DOCX, and PDF.
- Confirm exports contain the latest edited text and optional branding.
- Check that missing-key and backend-unavailable errors are clearly reported.

03 Deploy the application

- Choose hosting for the FastAPI backend and Streamlit frontend.
- Configure each service's start command and environment variables.
- Enable HTTPS and restrict access for the intended users.
- Verify that the deployed frontend connects to the deployed backend.

04 Protect user information

- Avoid storing drafts unless storage is explicitly added and disclosed.
- Do not log API keys or submitted document contents.
- Tell users not to enter highly sensitive or confidential information.
- Review the privacy and security settings of the selected hosting provider.

05 Prepare release materials

- Provide installation, configuration, and troubleshooting instructions.
- Explain local draft mode and Gemini-backed generation.
- State clearly that generated content is a starting draft, not legal advice.
- Recommend review by a qualified lawyer before signing or relying on a document.

06 Maintain the application

- Monitor service availability and provider errors.
- Review dependency updates and apply security fixes.
- Recheck the configured Gemini model and API access periodically.
- Keep a record of releases and notable changes.

Completion criteria

Phase 8 is complete when the deployed application is reachable, users can generate and edit a draft, all three export formats work, configuration secrets are not exposed, and users can find clear setup and legal-review guidance.

Deliverables

Deployed LegalEase frontend and backend; release configuration and environment-variable list; user setup and troubleshooting guide; release checklist and maintenance notes.

Risks and follow-up

AI-generated legal language may be inaccurate, incomplete, or unsuitable for a particular jurisdiction. Hosting configuration may also expose submitted information if privacy controls are not reviewed. Before public release, review deployment and privacy settings, and ask qualified legal professionals to review any templates intended for real use.